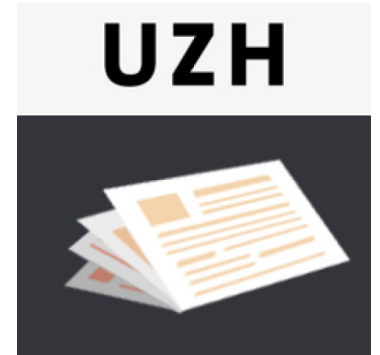




Informfully Research Platform

A Content Delivery Platform for User Studies

Research Team:

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Student Support:

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Imagine an app...

[Demo App]



Mobile App and Administration Website

Mobile App

- Android/iOS
- User tracking & in-app surveys
- Multimedia content (text, audio, and video)

Content Scraper

- Scraper for online news (text, audio, and video)
- Modularized data augmentations pipeline (clean, text normalization, picture recommendation, style rewriting, sentiment analysis)





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Setting everything up...

[Demo Web]



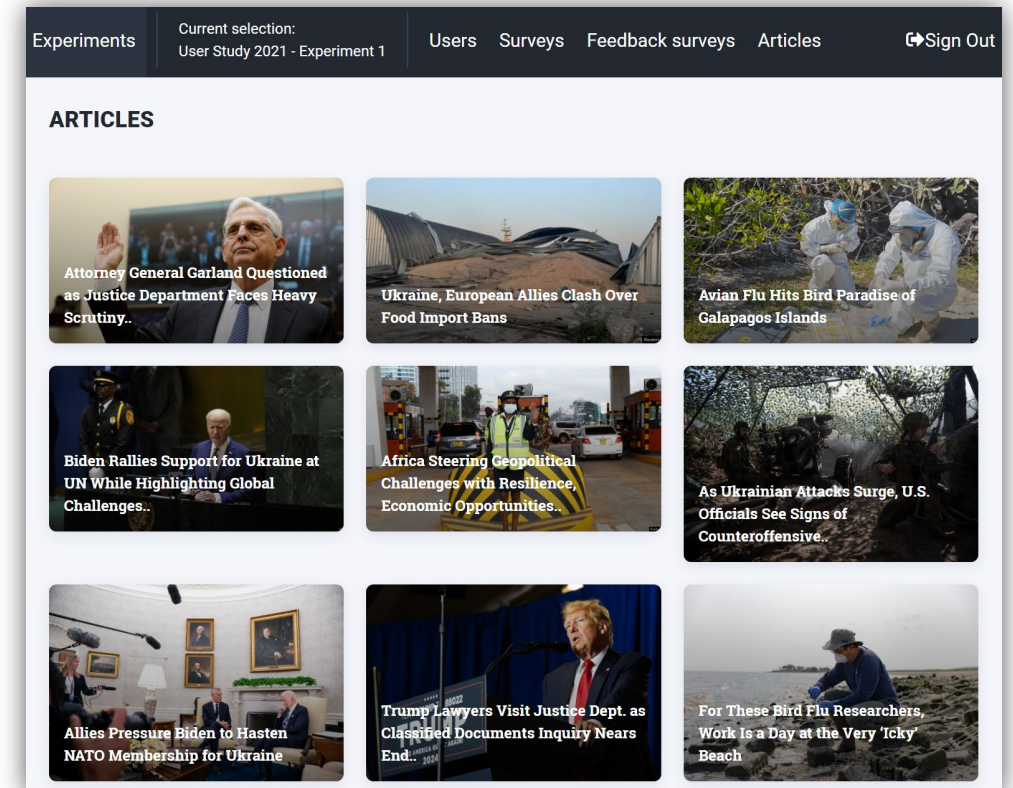
Content Scraper and Recommender Backend

Administration Website

- Set up experiments
- Generate user accounts
- Content curation
- Create & edit surveys

Recommender Backend

- Based on Cornac
- Web-based interface for creating experiments (data selection, split, models, metrics, and visualization).
- Diversity optimization (models and metrics)





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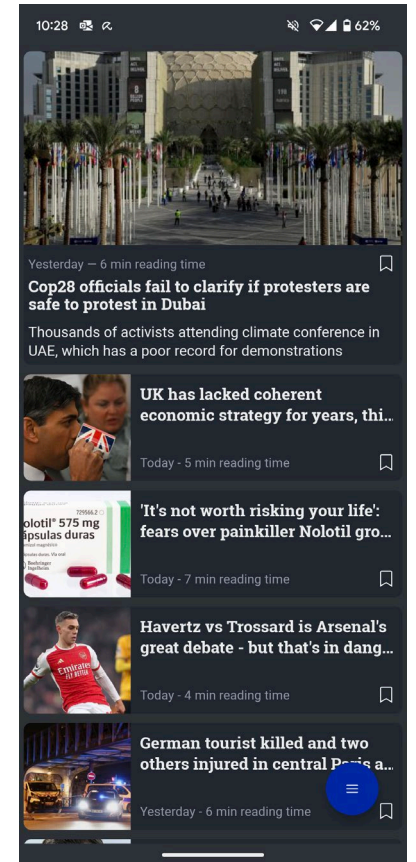


Use Case – Nudging of News



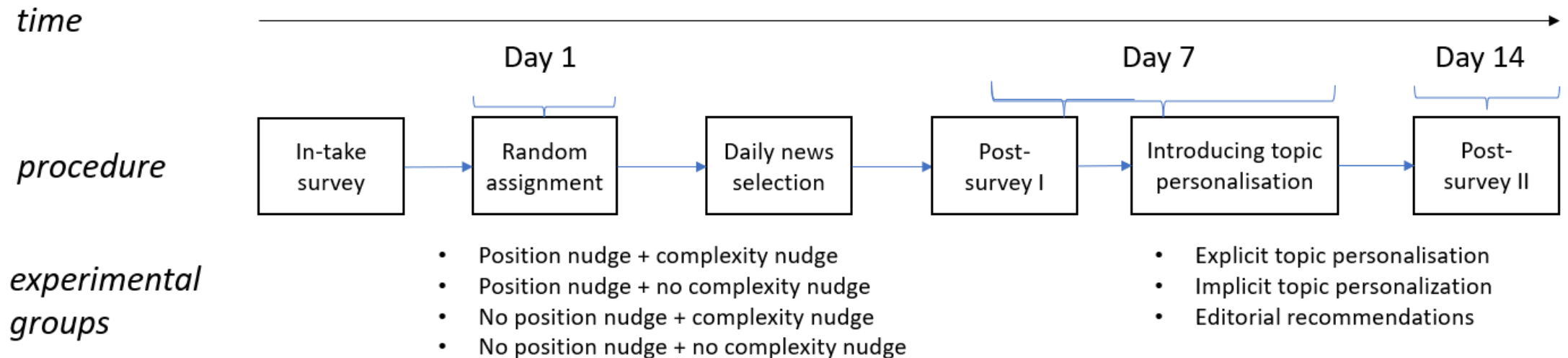
Current Field Experiment Background

- Background
 - Research into normatively-driven news recommender system design
 - Limits of lab-experiments (e.g. external validity, no longitudinal effects)
- Study objective
 - Test the effect of nudges on a) selection of, b) engagement with and c) learning from environmental news
 - Position nudge
 - Complexity nudge
 - Explore how the introduction of topic personalization affects users a) satisfaction, b) engagement, and c) perceived topic diversity





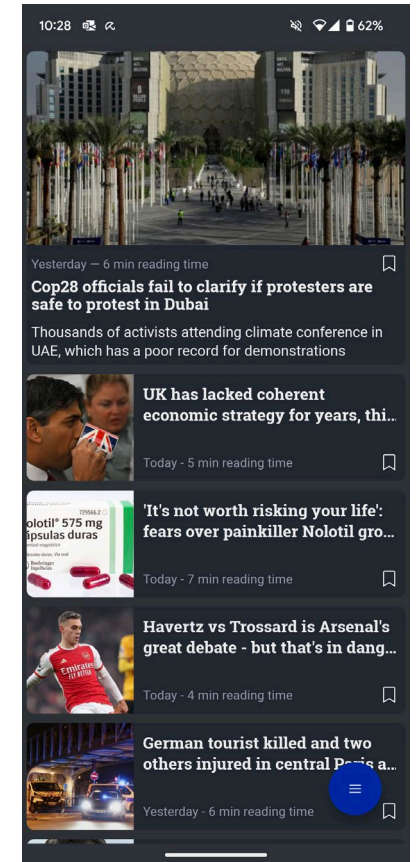
Informfully Field Experiment: What We Are Doing





Informfully Field Experiment: New Input vs. Out-of-the-Box Features

- News Supply: Web scrapers for six major UK news outlets
- Stimuli: Selecting and adapting the nudged articles
- Personalization: Recommendation algorithm (co-developed)
- Surveys: Questions





References

- [1] Heitz, L., Lischka, J. A., Abdullah, R., Laugwitz, L., Meyer, H., & Bernstein, A. (2023). Deliberative Diversity for News Recommendations: Operationalization and Experimental User Study. In *Proceedings of the 17th ACM Conference on Recommender Systems*, pp. 813-819.
- [2] Heitz, L., Lischka, J. A., Birrer, A., Paudel, B., Tolmeijer, S., Laugwitz, L., & Bernstein, A. (2022). Benefits of Diverse News Recommendations for Democracy: A User Study. *Digital Journalism*, 10(10), pp. 1710-1730.



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Thank You!

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